

Technical Screen Interview Guide



Welcome to your prep guide for your Embedded Software Engineer interview with Meta. Our engineering leaders and recruiters put together this guide so you know what to expect and how to prepare. We recognize that interviewing can be stressful, so we hope this guide provides the information and resources you need. Remember, your recruiter is there to support you, so please reach out to them with any questions.

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Accommodations process

Meta is committed to providing reasonable support (called accommodations) in our recruiting processes for qualified candidates with disabilities, physical conditions, mental health conditions, neurodivergence, sincerely held religious beliefs, pregnancy, childbirth, or related medical conditions, as required by law. If you need assistance or require an accommodation, reach out via the [Accommodations request form](#).

Interview process overview

What will your interview process be?

Meta seeks Embedded engineers who have the technical expertise and ability to solve deep, challenging problems and who can communicate in a clear and compelling way to a wide variety of stakeholders and across diverse subjects. This interview is designed to give you the opportunity to give us a sense of your technical skills. In addition to demonstrating technical expertise, we expect Meta engineers to effectively communicate technical and non-technical information, as well as be able to discuss driving and executing ideas across diverse teams and stakeholders.

Technical skills aren't the same as interview skills, so even the most experienced engineers need to prepare and practice to do well in an interview. It's difficult for interviewers to get a clear signal on coding ability from someone who hasn't practiced solving new problems under time constraints, so we recommend that even the most experienced engineers sharpen those skills in advance. Meta conducts most interviews remotely.

60-Minute Technical Screening Interview

Your interview will cover the following topics:

- Technical Leadership Experience and Scope
- Cross-Functional Collaboration
- Technical and Coding Skills

Video Conference interview best practices

- Make sure you're in a quiet environment.
- Double check that you have a reliable internet/phone connection.
- It's okay to ask the person you're speaking with to speak slowly if you can't catch what they're saying.
- You'll need a laptop with a webcam, speaker, and mic. We recommend using a headset or headphones with a mic for better quality audio, but this is optional.
- While we embrace the usage of advanced tooling in our day-to-day work to build the future of social connection, we ask that you not use any unauthorized outside assistance during interviews. Throughout the interview process you may be asked to share your screen via Zoom. Here you can find [guidance](#) on how this works. Additionally, we ask that you disable and not use filters during your interview. This will help us get an understanding of how you approach problem-solving and coding independently. Outside assistance includes, but is not limited to, consulting external resources, seeing help from others, or using AI tools, like ChatGPT.
 - For your interview, ensure Zoom screen sharing is enabled in advance, as setup may require a few minutes. Here's how: [Enable Zoom screen share](#).
 - A filter is considered any tool/feature that applies visual effects to your video feed, including virtual/blurred background.

Interview Dress Code

As you're probably aware, we promote a casual environment at Meta so that everyone can be their authentic selves. Formal dress is not required (jeans are definitely ok!). Dress comfortably. We care about what you can do, not what you wear.

What we look for - Behavioral

What can you expect?

In the first 15 - 20 minutes your interviewer will seek to understand the scope of your technical leadership experience and breadth and depth of your responsibilities. Your interviewer will also seek to understand how you handle challenging relationships and stakeholders.

Your interviewer may ask you to:

- Discuss past and current projects.
- Provide specific examples about what you did and the resulting impact.
- Share what you learned from a past situation.

Example questions may be similar to the following:

- Tell me about a successful initiative you worked on that required collaboration across teams.
- Tell me about a time you experienced a challenging relationship with another team.

How to prep

- Know yourself. Take the time to review your own résumé as your interviewer will almost certainly ask about key events in your work history.
- Be honest. Not every project is a runaway success and we may not always interact perfectly with our peers. Being transparent in these situations won't be counted against you in the interview. In fact, sharing & discussing how you learned, improved, and grew from your past experiences is valued.
- Use the S.T.A.R. method to mentally organize your thoughts. This provides a well-thought-out and chronological action of events that's easy to follow.
 - **S**—One or two sentences about the SITUATION: What happened?
 - **T**—Describe the TASK: What was your specific goal?

- **A**—ACTIONS you took to overcome the obstacles and complete your objective.
- **R**—The tangible / quantifiable RESULTS of the situation: How did it help the team / company?

- Have concrete examples or anecdotes. Support each question with practical experiences and examples. Avoid theoretical answers – if you go into a theoretical tangent, your interviewer will redirect you to provide a concrete example.

What we look for - Technical

This remaining 40 - 45 minute interview focuses heavily on coding. You'll be assessed on how you solve the problem as well as the structure and style of your code. Additionally, we want to hear your thought process throughout, so be sure to provide a narrative as you solve and code up your solutions.

The language you will code in may vary depending upon the specific role for which you are interviewing (see below for a list of languages by role). Please confirm the coding language preference with your recruiter in advance:

- Embedded: C, C++

In your coding interview, your interviewer will assess your performance on four focus areas:

- **Communication:** Are you asking for requirements and clarity when necessary, or are you just diving into the code? Your initial tech screen should be a conversation, so don't forget to ask questions and listen carefully to your interviewer.
- **Problem Solving:** How do you comprehend and explain complex ideas? Are you providing the reasoning behind a particular solution? Developing and comparing multiple solutions? Using appropriate data structures? Speaking about space and time complexity? Optimizing your solution?
- **Coding:** Can you convert solutions to executable code? Is the code organized and does it capture the right logical structure?
- **Verification:** Are you considering a reasonable number of test cases or coming up with a good argument for why your code is correct? Are you able to walk through your own logic to find bugs and explain what the code is doing?

How to prep

Your interview will focus on technical coding questions. In addition to the preparation guidance below, this [video](#) will give you an example of what to expect during your technical portion.

Before you practice, plan!

- Be honest with yourself—only you know how much prep time you'll need. Make the most of your prep time by following these steps to plan your approach before you start practicing.
- Schedule time to study and practice. Block out time every day to write code.
- Target medium and hard problems.
- Prioritize breadth over depth. It's much better to practice solving fewer example problems of many problem types than to become very familiar with one type at the expense of the others.
- Set aside time to review what you've practiced. As you solve problems, make cheat sheets or flash cards to review later. Revision and repetition will strengthen your understanding of core concepts.
- Remember your goal. Aim for confidently solving two questions—while thinking aloud—in about 35 minutes.

Topic Areas:

- Bit Manipulation and Operations (Bits and Bytes), binary arithmetic.
- Embedded Systems Fundamentals: Hardware timers and counters, Interrupt handling, Real-time systems and scheduling.
- System Programming: Endianness detection, Memory Management.

Use key practice strategies to practice effectively

- Reading through sample questions, recognizing concepts, and having a vague understanding of these concepts won't be enough to help you shine. You need to practice! Make sure you're setting your practice sessions up for success by following these tips from engineers who've been through the process.
- Practice coding the way you'll code during your tech screen. Use CoderPad.io if your interview is via phone or video call.

- Set a time constraint when you practice problems. In your tech screen, you'll be asked to solve two problems in under 35 minutes. Practice coding solutions to medium problems in less than 15 minutes each to help you be ready for the constraints during the interview.
- Provide the most efficient solution, find and fix the bugs yourself.
- Practice talking through the problem space and possible solutions before you dive in and talk through your decisions out loud as you code. Interviewers will be evaluating your thought process as well as your coding abilities. Explaining your decisions as you code is crucial to helping them understand your choices. The more you practice this, the more natural it will feel during the interview.
- Don't be surprised if the questions sound contrived. Problems may be different than what you're probably tackling in a day-to-day job. We don't ask "puzzle" questions, but questions may be different than real-world problems because they need to be described and solved in 10-20 minutes.
- Problems may assess the depth of your knowledge and your versatility. For example, your interviewer might ask you to solve a problem any way you want. Then, they could add constraints on the running or space characteristics and ask you to solve it again.
- Problems may focus on edge cases. You might be asked to parse some data format or mini language. Your answers demonstrate your ability to handle multiple states in your head.
- Problems may test how well you know how things work under the hood. For example, you might be asked to implement well-known library functions.

How to approach problems during your interview

1. Before you code

- Ask clarifying questions. Talk through the problem and ask follow-up questions to make sure you understand the exact problem you're trying to solve before you jump into building the solution.
- Let us know if you've seen the problem previously. That will help us understand your context.
- Present multiple potential solutions, if possible. Talk through which solution you're choosing and why.

2. While you code

- Don't forget to talk! While your tech screen will focus heavily on coding, the engineer you're interviewing with will also be evaluating your thought process. Explaining your decisions and actions as you go will help the interviewer understand your choices.
- Be flexible. Some problems have elegant solutions, and some must be brute forced. If you get stuck, just describe your best approach, and ask the interviewer if you should go that route. It's much better to have non-optimal but working code than just an idea with nothing written down.
- Iterate rather than immediately trying to jump to the clever solution. If you can't explain your concept clearly in five minutes, it's probably too complex.

After you code

- Validate your solution. Think like a compiler. Walk through the code using test cases to evaluate correctness.
- Expect questions. The interviewer may tweak the problem a bit to test your knowledge and see if you can come up with another answer and/or further optimize your solution.
- Take the interviewer's hints to improve your code. If the interviewer suggests or asks a question, listen fully so you can incorporate any hints they may provide.
- Ask yourself if you would approve your solution as part of your codebase. Explain your answer to your interviewer. Make sure your solution is correct and efficient, that you've considered edge cases, and that it clearly reflects the ideas you're trying to express in your code.

Appendix / Resources

Below is a curated list of resources to get started and help you prepare.

Coding resources

- [Software Engineering Interview Q+A Video](#)
- [Cracking the Meta Coding Interview Videos \(The Approach and Problem Walk-through\)](#)(password: FB IPS)
- [HackerRank website](#)
- [CoderPad website](#)

- [Topcoder website](#)
- [GeeksQuiz website](#)
- [CareerCup website](#)

Meta resources

- [About Meta](#) website
- [Meta Newsroom](#) website
- [Meta Careers](#) website
- [Culture at Meta](#) website
- [Meta employee benefits](#) website
- [Interviewing at Meta: The keys to success](#) blog

Update personal information, track interview progress, and send thank you notes.

At any time during the interview process, you can track your progress, send thank-you notes and update your personal information all via the [Career Profile](#). If you do not receive a link from recruiting, you may create one.

Thank you for taking the time to review this guide!